Adam Hickey

Senior Product Designer · Complex Workflows · Design Systems · Prototyping in Code · AI and Agentic Products

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Professional summary

Senior product designer with 20 years on complicated software, for organizations including Cargill, Intel, CBRE and Toro. I began as a designer-developer, building front ends in HTML, CSS and jQuery; spent thirteen years leading enterprise product design and design systems at scale; and now design and build working products with coding agents. I bring enterprise workflow experience, interaction design and hands-on prototyping in code to teams working out what software should do on its own and where a person still decides.

Experience

Selected Independent Work — Product design, systems, prototyping 2026 – Present

- **Agent Review** — Designed and built, with Claude Code, a React and TypeScript prototype for delegating UI work to coding agents. Defined the agent's boundaries, twelve written design rules, and automated visual and accessibility checks; ran the same feature with and without the rules to find where automation ends and human judgment begins.
- **Dispatch Cockpit** — Designed a decision-support prototype for AI-assisted load assignment, making evidence, confidence, overrides and the manual path visible to expert dispatchers.
- **Lucy Learns** and **Door County Found** — two products in use, defined, designed and built end to end: an offline-first training app and a regional travel guide built on structured data.

RBA Inc — Lead UX Product Designer 2013 – 2026

- Led enterprise product design and UX strategy for clients in logistics, manufacturing, healthcare, financial services, and the public sector, including compliance-sensitive work for a federal agency, a regional bank and healthcare providers.
- Tied design decisions to the numbers product, engineering and business teams already track: efficiency, adoption, quality, ROI.
- Built and governed design systems across SAP, Microsoft, Umbraco, and Sitecore platforms: tokens, component libraries, contribution rules and release checkpoints; designed and built Connect, the firm's own design-system site. Led accessibility, DesignOps and governance practices.
- Used AI to scale the design system: drafting documentation, auditing for drift, checking design against code, and pulling research together. Human judgment on every decision.

Pixel Farm — Interactive Designer / Developer Jan 2008 – Apr 2013

Shipped two native iOS apps and an iPad app, plus configurator and store-locator builds for Lund Boats and Fulton Beer. Built front-end experiences in HTML, CSS and jQuery across Joomla! and WordPress; led rebrands and visual identity systems.

LEVEL — Interactive Designer Jan 2006 – Jan 2008

Designed and built front-end websites in HTML, CSS, and Flash with project managers, creative leads, writers, and developers.

ByDesign — Design Intern 2004 – 2006

Selected projects

- Scaling enterprise product design across 40+ SAP applications: one design system and accessibility standard, about a third less time from design to development, and UI defects in production cut roughly in half.
- Cutting data-analysis requests from 45–55 hours to just over 10 with a USDA grant-management portal (research, workflows, accessibility).
- Orchestrating real-time logistics for a 450+ truck fleet: cockpit UI, fleet visibility and the decision surface itself, for a dispatcher who is short on attention rather than short on data.

Core capabilities

Product Strategy · UX & Interaction Design · Information Architecture · Research & Usability · Complex Workflows · Design Systems & Governance · Accessibility · Decision-Support Interfaces · Human–AI Interaction · Agentic Workflows · AI Autonomy & Escalation · Design-to-Code Systems

Tools & platforms

Used professionally, by hand (2005–2013): HTML · CSS · JavaScript/jQuery · Flash · WordPress · Joomla!
Build with now, through coding agents: React · TypeScript · Storybook · Playwright · Vitest & axe · Git/GitHub · Claude Code (skills, plugins, MCP)
Design & platforms: Figma/FigJam (variables, Dev Mode, component libraries) · CSS custom properties (tokens) · ChatGPT & Gemini · SAP Fiori · Sitecore · Umbraco · WCAG 2.1 AA

Education

Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design, University of Minnesota–Twin Cities (2005)